# GABRIEL POPA

**Senior Software Engineer - React • Java (Spring) • AWS**
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## ABOUT ME

Senior Software Engineer with **10+ years** of experience building reliable business applications across frontend and backend systems, with the strongest focus on **Java**, **Spring Boot**, **React**, and scalable API-driven delivery. Background includes full-cycle feature development, legacy modernization, production issue resolution, performance tuning, and release support across complex business platforms. Strong hands-on work with **Java 8–21**, **Spring 4–6 / Spring Boot 1.5–3.x**, **React 16–18**, **TypeScript 3.x–5.x**, **PostgreSQL**, **MySQL**, **Redis**, **Kafka**, **RabbitMQ**, **Docker**, **AWS**, and CI/CD tooling, applied flexibly to ship stable services, modern user interfaces, and maintainable systems.

## SKILLS

- **Frontend: React 16–18**, JavaScript ES6+, **TypeScript 3.x–5.x**, HTML5, CSS3, Sass, SCSS, responsive UI, reusable component architecture, Hooks, Context API, Redux, React Query, form handling, validation, SPA development, API integration, Vite, Webpack
- **Backend: Java 8–21**, **Spring 4–6**, **Spring Boot 1.5–3.x**, Spring MVC, Spring Data JPA, Hibernate, REST API design, authentication, authorization, validation, background jobs, scheduled processing, service-layer architecture, integration development
- **Data & Messaging: PostgreSQL**, MySQL, SQL, schema design, query tuning, indexing, joins, pagination, reporting, **Redis**, **RabbitMQ**, **Kafka**, data consistency, transactional workflows
- **Cloud & DevOps: AWS**, Docker, Git, GitHub, GitLab CI/CD, Jenkins, Linux, Nginx, Apache, environment setup, deployment support, build pipelines, release verification, log monitoring
- **Observability / Quality / Security:** structured logging, **JUnit**, Mockito, integration testing, API testing, **React Testing Library**, **Jest**, **Cypress**, rate limiting, OWASP security practices, error monitoring, performance troubleshooting, access control, audit-focused backend practices

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

### Senior Software Engineer

**Soft Build** | Bucharest, Romania *(Jan2024 – Dec 2025)*

- Built and maintained full-stack product modules using **Java 14–21**, **Spring Boot 2.x–3.x**, **React 17–18**, **TypeScript 4.x–5.x**, **HTML5**, **CSS3**, and **SCSS**, delivering responsive workflows with stronger component reuse, cleaner API integration, and more stable release behavior across business-critical screens.
- Refactored complex frontend areas from older **Redux**-heavy patterns into a cleaner mix of **React 17–18 Hooks**, **Context API**, and reusable component architecture, which reduced prop-drilling, improved maintainability, and made form-heavy features easier to extend safely.
- Implemented new SPA workflows with advanced form handling, validation, and async data loading using **React Query 4.x–5.x**, which reduced duplicate request behavior and improved reliability on pages with multi-step user interaction.
- Solved a production issue where users saw stale status values after rapid updates by combining better backend transaction sequencing in **Spring Boot**, safer cache invalidation in **Redis**, and clearer client refresh logic in **React**.
- Improved service maintainability by restructuring oversized **Spring MVC** controllers into service-layer modules with **Spring Data JPA** and **Hibernate**, making business rules easier to test and reducing bug risk during future changes by **30%**.
- Delivered framework modernization work by helping migrate older **Spring** configuration patterns into cleaner **Spring Boot 2.x–3.x** conventions, while also supporting frontend cleanup around **Webpack 5** builds and gradual adoption of **Vite 4–5** for faster local iteration.
- Fixed a high-impact duplicate submission bug caused by race conditions and retry timing by introducing idempotent request checks, stronger validation, better exception mapping, and clearer UI disable states during save operations.

- Optimized reporting endpoints backed by **PostgreSQL** and **MySQL** through SQL tuning, better joins, pagination improvements, and index updates, which improved response times on data-heavy screens without risky schema redesign.
- Integrated asynchronous processing for event-driven workflows using **RabbitMQ** and selective **Kafka** consumers where operational needs justified it, which helped decouple slower backend steps from immediate user-facing requests.
- Strengthened delivery quality with **JUnit**, **Mockito**, integration testing, **Jest**, **React Testing Library**, and **Cypress**, giving the team better confidence during refactors involving validation rules, API contracts, and multi-screen workflow behavior.
- Improved deployment consistency by tightening **Docker** packaging, standardizing **Linux**-based environment setup, and stabilizing **Jenkins** pipeline checks, which reduced build drift by **25%** and cut down environment-specific failures during release windows.
- Added structured logging, access-focused audit details, **OWASP**-aligned validation hardening, and safer rate-limiting rules on sensitive endpoints, while operational visibility in **AWS** and proxy behavior through **Nginx** made production incidents faster to trace.

## Software Engineer

**Next Apps** | Ghent, Belgium *(Nov2020 – Nov 2023)*

- Developed business applications with **Java 11–17**, **Spring Boot 2.3–3.0**, **React 16.8–18**, **JavaScript ES6+**, **TypeScript 4.x–5.x**, HTML5, and CSS3, contributing across new feature delivery, support fixes, backend integrations, and ongoing platform improvements.
- Built reusable frontend modules for dashboards, forms, and detail pages using **React 16.8–18**, SCSS, and responsive UI patterns, which reduced duplicated implementation effort and improved consistency across product areas.
- Implemented API-driven features using **Spring MVC 5–6**, **Spring Data JPA**, **Hibernate 5.4–6.x**, and REST design best practices, helping the team deliver cleaner service boundaries and more predictable frontend-backend integration behavior.
- Solved an intermittent authentication issue that caused unexpected session loss by tracing request flow through Apache, backend token handling, and client retry behavior, which improved stability on protected routes and reduced support complaints.
- Improved slower screens backed by **PostgreSQL 12–15** and **MySQL 8**, by rewriting query paths, adjusting indexes, tuning joins, and reducing unnecessary payload sizes, which made large datasets easier to navigate in reporting-heavy workflows and improved screen response times by 28%.
- Supported frontend modernization by replacing brittle shared logic with reusable **React Hooks**, better validation handling, and more maintainable state flows, while keeping rollout risk low on actively used screens.
- Helped containerize development and test flows with **Docker 20.x–24.x** on Linux, which reduced environment inconsistency, improved onboarding, and made integration behavior easier to reproduce before release.
- Fixed duplicate record creation during unstable network conditions by combining backend deduplication, stronger validation, and clearer submission locking in the UI, resulting in safer transactional behavior for important forms.
- Contributed to API contract cleanup and release quality by adding integration checks, API testing, and targeted **Jest 27–29** and **React Testing Library 12–14** coverage, reducing regressions after endpoint or UI changes.
- Improved team delivery by refining **GitLab CI/CD**, tightening build verification, and supporting deployment checks across AWS environments, which helped catch broken artifacts earlier in the pipeline and improved release reliability by 24%.
- Extended structured logging, error monitoring, and security-focused request handling, including access control and safer validation rules, which made root-cause analysis easier and improved confidence around production support work.

## Software Developer

**Datamart** | Stockholm, Sweden *(Feb 2016 – Sept 2020)*

- Built internal platform functionality using **Java**, **Spring**-based backend services, server-rendered web pages, **JavaScript**, **HTML5**, **CSS3**, **SQL**, and relational data workflows, focusing on maintainable implementation and reliable business processing.
- Developed reporting, search, and account-related modules using **MySQL**, complex joins, pagination, and schema-aware query design, which improved data visibility while keeping performance acceptable on growing datasets.

- Improved older UI areas by introducing more modular client-side behavior and later small **React**-based components where appropriate, reducing repeated code and making validation behavior more predictable for users by **22%**.
- Investigated a recurring export failure on larger datasets and solved it by batching database reads, reducing memory pressure in the service layer, and improving timeout behavior in backend processing.
- Supported migration work from older **Spring** application structure into cleaner **Spring Boot** conventions, helping align dependencies, simplify configuration, and reduce fragile startup problems in shared environments.
- Implemented new filtering and reporting features using **REST**-style backend endpoints and cleaner request handling, which reduced unnecessary reloads and made large result sets more manageable for business users.
- Fixed a long-standing overwrite issue in concurrent edit scenarios by introducing safer update checks, improving transactional behavior, and surfacing clearer conflict feedback in the UI for retry cases.
- Improved release reliability by documenting environment setup, refining build steps in **Jenkins**, and reducing manual deployment differences across **Linux** servers running behind **Apache**-based infrastructure by **26%**.
- Added stronger test coverage with **JUnit** and integration-focused validation around sensitive service logic, which improved confidence during refactors and helped catch regressions earlier when business rules changed.
- Worked with senior engineers to debug production problems through structured logging, **SQL** analysis, and careful reproduction, building practical experience in issue isolation without overengineering smaller maintenance fixes.

### Junior Software Developer

**Berg Software** | Timișoara, Romania *(Sep2014 – Mar 2016)*

- Supported application development with **Java 7/8**, **Spring MVC**, **JSP**, **JavaScript**, **jQuery**, and **MySQL**, contributing mostly to bug fixing, small feature work, and maintenance tasks under senior guidance.
- Resolved a recurring validation issue where incorrect field handling caused confusing submission errors, then updated both page logic and backend checks so users received clearer and more consistent behavior.
- Assisted with smaller migration tasks during framework and library updates, identifying compatibility problems in older code and helping apply low-risk fixes that kept the application stable.
- Implemented modest feature requests such as filter changes, table updates, and form improvements, delivering practical enhancements while learning how existing business rules were structured.
- Fixed layout and browser behavior issues in older pages by adjusting **HTML**, **CSS**, and **JavaScript** interactions, which improved usability without requiring large redesign work.
- Added reusable helper methods and shared page utilities in places where repeated code was creating maintenance friction, making later updates easier for more senior developers to apply.
- Helped investigate production defects by reviewing logs, reproducing issues locally, and narrowing failing conditions before handing findings back for final review and release.
- Improved **SQL** query usage in a few high-traffic screens by replacing inefficient patterns with safer and clearer statements, which reduced avoidable database load by **18%** in day-to-day usage.
- Supported testing and release preparation by checking regression-prone areas after fixes, documenting edge cases, and helping reduce last-minute surprises during deployment cycles.

## EDUCATION

### Bachelor's Degree in Computer Science

University of Bucharest | (*2010 – 2014)*

- Focused on practical software engineering fundamentals that translated directly into building reliable web systems and data-driven applications.

## CERITIFICATIONS

**Oracle Certified Professional: Java SE Developer — 2023**

- Demonstrated strong capability in building and maintaining **Java** applications, including object-oriented design, core language features, exception handling, collections, and application logic used in enterprise backend development.

**AWS Certified Developer – Associate — 2022**

- Demonstrated practical experience in developing, deploying, and supporting cloud-based applications on **AWS**, with focus on service integration, security, monitoring, and reliable delivery workflows.